

SHANG WU

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260 Aldrich Hall, Irvine, CA, 92697

RESEARCH INTERESTS

I am broadly interested in human–AI interaction, AI evaluation/benchmarking, and uncertainty quantification, with a focus on developing cognitively-inspired methods to evaluate and improve AI systems.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Computer Science University of California, Irvine Advisor: Padhraic Smyth	09/2023 - Present
M.S. in Computer Science University of California, Irvine GPA 3.96/4.00	09/2023 - 03/2025
B.S. in Computer Science and Psychology with Honors University of California, Davis GPA 4.00/4.00	09/2020 - 03/2023

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Researcher University of California, Irvine, Computer Science Department	09/2023 - Present
Research Assistant University of California, Davis, Psychology Department	06/2022 - 03/2023
University of California, Davis, Animal Science Department	02/2022 - 05/2022

SKILLS

Machine Learning · Deep Learning · Large Language Models (LLMs) · Model Evaluation & Benchmarking · Uncertainty Quantification
Statistical & Bayesian Modeling · Experimental Design · Human–AI Interaction · User Studies · Crowdsourced Data Analysis
Python (PyTorch, scikit-learn, NumPy, pandas, matplotlib, Stan) · C++ · Java · Git
English · Mandarin

PUBLICATIONS

- Belém, C., **Wu, S.**, Yao, H., Steyvers, M., Singh, S., Smyth, P., From ‘May’ to ‘Is’: Certainty Distortion in Language Model Rewriting. *EMNLP 2026*
- Wu, S.**, Belém, C., Fu, S., Steyvers, M., Smyth, P., How AI Assistance Affects Human Skill Development: A Study of Learning with Logic Puzzles. *HCOMP 2026*
- Wu, S.**, Yao, H., Belém, C., Fu, S., Steyvers, M., Smyth, P., The Impact of AI Usage and Informativeness on Skill Development in Logical Reasoning. *HHAI 2026*

Longjohn, R., **Wu, S.**, Kher, S., Belém, C., Smyth, P., Bayesian evaluation of blackbox LLM behavior. *NeurIPS 2025 Workshop on Evaluating the Evolving LLM Lifecycle: Benchmarks, Emergent Abilities, and Scaling*

WORKING PAPER

Wu, S., Kher, S., Smyth, P., Learning to assign prediction tasks to agents with capacity constraints. *Under Review*

Wu, S., Yao, H., AI evaluation may bias perceptions: The importance of context in interpreting academic writing. *Under Review*

FELLOWSHIPS & AWARDS

HPI Research Center Fellowship	01/2025
UCI ICS Dean's Fellowship	06/2024
Thomas E. Bruzzone Scholarship	12/2022
Charles R. Bishop Award	09/2022
2021 Michael's Scholarship	01/2022

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

Wu. S., Understanding human-AI dynamics in interactive decision-making tasks, *Collective Intelligence 2025 Demos and Posters*.

TEACHING

Student Assistant - UC Davis Computer Science Department	04/2022 - 06/2022
Course: Software Development & Object-Oriented Programming in C++.	
Peer Tutor – UC Davis Academic Assistance and Tutoring Centers	10/2021 - 03/2023
Programming, mathematics, and statistics.	